



Vitality Bowls - AI Growth Engine Summary

TKH Data Science Technology Fellowship - Hackathon Group 2		
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Bill Neblock is the owner of the first Vitality Bowls franchise location in Connecticut. Vitality Bowls is a superfood food cafe that was founded in 2011 San Ramon, California by a wife and husband duo - much like our clients, the Neblocks. The chain specializes in açai bowls made with a thick blend of açai berry topped with organic granola and superfood ingredients, along with smoothies, fresh juices, soups, salads, and paninis. These all made fresh to order in kitchens designed to avoid cross-contact with common food allergens. Since franchising began in 2014, the brand has grown to more than 100 cafés across the country. In the Stamford, CT area there's a growing number of healthy fast-casual dining options. With DIG and CHOPT as strong aspirant benchmarks, Vitality Bowls Stamford has an opportunity to grow its market share and build a similar following.

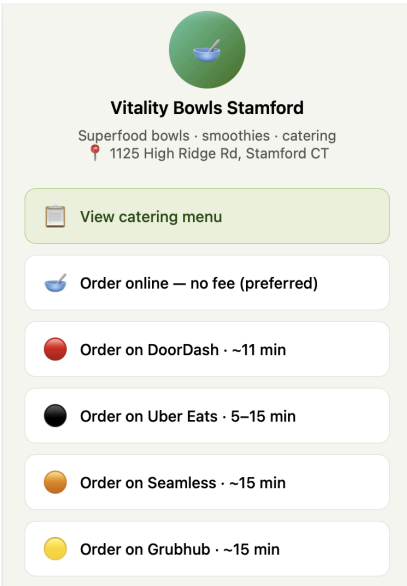
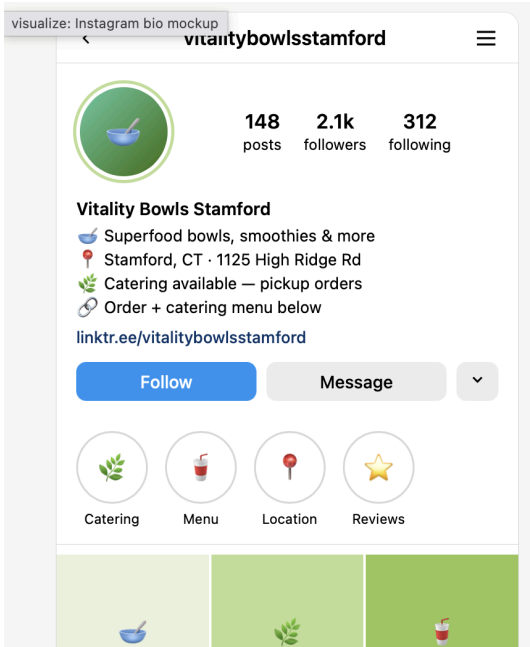
Vitality Bowls Stamford, with its High Ridge Road location, is positioned in a high-opportunity wellness corridor surrounded by corporate offices, medical buildings, fitness centers, and thousands of potential catering customers. Since opening about 8 months ago, the Neblocks have come across a few business areas that can use improvement to boost their overall visibility, revenue, and time. They fall within two categories. The first being lack of a structured system for targeted local outreach. The Neblocks have been unable to identify the right local audiences and create on-brand content/offers for them. In the past, they have had unsuccessful experiences investing a marketing budget with an ad agency that led them to be uncertain of the financial return of their investment and without a way to track the ads impact. The second category is a lack of inbound pipeline of catering leads as well as a system to track and manage them. The Neblocks have done in-person outreach to neighboring business owners and maintained a friendly relationship with them but, it is not translating into a consistent stream of catering inquiries which would provide a significant increase in revenue.

Our team's AI driven solutions to these problems comes from their prime location nestled between medical offices and wellness centered business. We built an AI-powered tool that helps Vitality Bowls Stamford better understand their surrounding market, pinpoint the best customer segments for both social media and catering outreach, and automatically craft messaging that fits each audience. Most importantly, it is all designed to be simple enough for a busy owner-operator to manage completely on their own. The dashboard is broken up into 5 parts: (1) Pipeline; (2) Outreach & Approvals; (3) Prospect Finder; (4) Ad + Content Studio; (5) Roadmap.

Pipeline tracks every catering lead end-to-end, with AI-drafted responses and automatic follow-up sequences that trigger the moment an inquiry comes in. **Outreach & Approvals** consolidates five channels into one weekly queue where the owner can review and approve AI-generated outreach in about 8 minutes. **Prospect Finder** scans and scores nearby businesses by catering fit, drafting outreach automatically at the click of a button. **Ad & Content Studio** generates ready-to-approve social posts and targeted ads across Meta, Google, and Nextdoor, with a budget slider showing exactly what each dollar can possibly deliver.

Roadmap will layer in Toast POS integration, loyalty rewards, advanced ad intelligence, and a review engine — connecting everything into one fully unified system by month six.

In addition to this AI dashboard, we created a mockup of simple and quick changes to their franchise's Instagram account based on examples of other franchises that can be implemented immediately. As of now the Vitality Bowls Stamford (@vitalitybowlsstamford) Instagram biography is empty. We suggest adding a LinkTree that directs potential customers directly to their booking site for catering as well as to third party delivery couriers. Adding a more detailed Instagram bio that contains location and times also creates a more engaging experience for people that will come across their page. In addition, we suggest adding pinned story highlights for personal franchise images and videos. These changes will not only streamline users to their catering needs but improve online engagement and visibility.



PHASE 1 Get live & start approving	Week 1-4
Update Instagram biography and links	
Get familiar with the dashboard	
Add brand materials to the system	
Review AI drafts	
Set initial advertising budget	
PHASE 2 Connect the system & scale	Month 2-6
Transition system to a custom URL	
Private login for the owner, managers, and relevant personnel	
Integrate Toast POS credentials	
Integrate Incentivo credentials	
Review automations (i.e. lead, approval, follow-up) on quarterly basis to adjust as needed	